কালীবাড়ি খবর

KALIBARI NEWS

(Registered Charity 1158269)
Visit us at: www.londonkalibari.org.uk

Kalibari Centre: 18 Byron Road, Wealdstone, Harrow, HA3 7ST
Issue 18, April 2018

From the Trustee Chairman

Dear Kalibari Members and Friends
Welcome to the first Newsletter of 2018. As has become customary at this time of the year, I extend my welcome to those (lucky ones!) who have recently returned from India after a long winter break. Also I thank those who have helped us to keep going with activities such as the Monday Luncheon Club during this time.

We are greatly saddened at the death of one of our founder members, Dr Ratna Chatterjee. A short eulogy is included in this Newsletter on page 5.

We are also very sorry to announce the death of Mrs Pratima Lahiri. More information about her is given in the Community Corner on page 6.

London Kalibari is run by a set of trustees (six at present) elected at the Annual General Meeting. There is also a Core Support Group (CSG) of regular helpers. We hold around six Trustee Meetings during the year and regular members are invited to attend these meetings as observers. We are always looking for volunteers – Kalibari is a community organisation and it is as successful as our volunteers and members make it.

We continue to look for a suitable permanent property that will allow us to hold community activities. I thank all the members who make regular monthly payments or make generous donations from time to time.

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London Main Office 020 7457 1515
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General Secretary's Report:
After the winter exodus, LKB is again ready to resume. We started with a Satyanarayan Pujo on Sunday 25th March. We had 51 devotees, which is exceptionally good. We ideally would like to celebrate two Narayan Pujos, two Kali Pujos, main Diwali/Kalipujo, and cultural programmes every year. The operating window is effectively eight months.
Our website is being updated with relevant Pujo and other information. We are thankful to Avishek Chaudhuri. We are also trying to inform our members and supporters via global email.
We still intend to purchase the present venue. The progress is somewhat slow, not for lack of trying on our part.
We are happy to accommodate if anyone wishes to use the Centre for private celebrations. Our next Kalipujo is on May 13th Sunday about 12.30pm. Look forward to seeing you all there.
Joy Ma Kali

Treasurer's Statement:
a) Income & Expenditure: (regular per month)

Income –	Standing Order	£270
	Lunch'n Club	£70*
	Donations	£30
	Hall Hire	£30
	Utsav/Events	£100
	Total	£500
Expenditure -	Rent	£500
	Utilities	£70
	Council Tax	£30 (Govt. Relief)
	Total	£600
Shortfall **		£100

* In the Luncheon club (every Monday), one member in turn donates the food and all contributions (nominally £3/head) from other members go to the fund
** Large donations make up the shortfall and leave a surplus for the Building Fund

b) We have a Building Fund and some members pay by monthly standing order. Please ask one of the Trustees if you wish to have further information.

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Cultural Secretary's Report

The year 2018 brings us new hope and possibilities. Our fund-raising effort for our Building Fund continues. We feel very encouraged with great support from our members and well-wishers.

On Thursday 19 October 2017, we held our annual Kalipujo at the Harrow Arts Centre. As usual, there was a very good turnout of devotees and we had a most successful celebration. On Saturday 4 November we celebrated Bijoya at Harrow Civic Centre with a variety performance of music and dance and this was also well attended. On Friday 15 December we held a Christmas party at the Kalibari Centre and also held a musical evening at the Centre on Saturday 30 December.

This year, on Sunday 25 March we held a Narayan Puja at the Centre – sponsored by Arunima Roy, Debjani Sengupta and another person (who does not wish to be named).

Clarification of sponsoring the pujas. It costs around £400 to hold a puja. This covers food, puja expenses etc. When the puja is sponsored by one or more people, the minimum contribution is £50 per person. If the full cost is not met by sponsorship, the shortfall is made up from the donations at the door. The rest of the money donated goes to the building fund.

Please see below on: 1) Kanu Roy is organizing a Nababarsha/ Rabindra Jayanti celebration on Saturday 26 May and 2) with the support of Sushmita Bhattacharya, we are staging an event with local artists on 7 July.

Forthcoming Events 2018

1. Kalipuja – Sunday 13 May at Kalibari Centre, 12.30pm
2. Nababarsha/Rabindra Jayanti – Saturday 26 May at Harrow Civic Centre, Members Lounge, 6.30pm, free car parking. Artists include Sandip, Kakoli, Banani, Sreeya and Debabrata (further information coming soon)
3. Musical Evening - Saturday 7 July at Flash Musical, Methuen Road, Edgware, HA8 6EZ , free car parking in the streets (further information coming soon)
4. Main Kalipuja – Tuesday 6 November at Harrow Arts Centre, 6.00pm to 11pm, free car parking

Every Monday – Luncheon Club from 1pm to 4pm

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London Kalibari wishes to thank the following:

1. London Kalibari Life Members.
2. Supporters and helpers from the Community.
3. Harrow Council for Accommodation and Rate Support.
4. Harrow Art Centre for Diwali/Kalipuja.
5. Recent large contributors (above £500 and giving by Standing Order).
6. Mr Navin Shah, GLA Member, Wealdstone Labour Hall, for arranging the rental of the Kalibari Centre.
7. Mr Gareth Thomas, MP for Harrow West, Labour Party for his support.
8. Councillors of Harrow Council for their support and encouragement.
9. Sponsors of Kalibari events & activities.
10. Ms Tanuka Saha, of N. Saha & Co. Chartered Accountants
11. Sri Robin Ray, Kalibari Priest
12. Our local artists, Arijit Chakravarty and Debabrata Dey
13. Mrs Kakali Sengupta (Paris) for music
14. Mr Avishek Chaudhuri for website

Please note: Our intention is that when we have acquired a permanent centre, all contributions will be acknowledged, and those contributing significant amounts will be specially named (such as on a board or on a plaque).

Donations: Please make cheques payable to London Kalibari and send them to 13 Kenton Gardens, Harrow, Middlesex, HA3 8DE. For donations by Standing Orders, please contact the Treasurer, Mrinal Choudhury.

Trustees:
Dr Sudin Mandal (Chair), Mrs Jayati Das (Secretary), Mr Mrinal Choudhury (Treasurer), Mrs Krishna Ghosh, Mrs Debjani Sengupta and Dr Satya Chatterjee.

Core Support Group
Mrs Rama Choudhury, Mrs Gita Dutta, Mr Ajit Ghosh, Mrs Babli Mazumdar, Mr Kanu Roy, Mr Snehangshu Basu, Mrs Giti Ray and Mrs Dipti Chatterjee.

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RATNA CHATTERJEE



Ratna was born in Delhi on 16 November 1945. She married Ashok Chatterjee in 1965 while still a medical student and moved to the UK in 1968. She was multifaceted, alongside being a dedicated wife, mother and grandmother, she was a caring friend and a competent doctor, specialising in ophthalmology, and practising at Charing Cross and Moorfield Eye Hospitals. She was also a committee member of the BMA and was a school governor.

Ratna was married for nearly 50 years. Her daughter Odeeti was born in 1975. She took great pride in Odeeti's success in school, at Oxford, and then as a lawyer. Odeeti married Roger in 2009 and Ratna adored her grandchildren, Ananda, Sraboni and Asha. She loved cooking for her family and entertaining friends, often cooking for large parties. She was a very good dressmaker and seamstress. She had huge pride in her family background, and would tell her own family heroic tales of the parts they played in the fight for Indian independence.

She loved travelling. Her family remembers her as a free spirit. Up to the end she enjoyed trying new experiences such as visiting the London Eye and having lunch at the Shard.

Ratna was a founder member of London Kalibari and for many years its President in which capacity she worked hard. She continued her association with Kalibari until the end. When diagnosed with cancer she approached destiny with dignity and courage. She passed away on 14 December 2017. She will be sadly missed and we express our sincere sympathies to her family.

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Ms Tanuka Saha
N. Saha & Co., Chartered Accountants, 133 The Broadway,
Mill Hill, London NW7 4RN (London Kalibari Accountant)

www.nsaha.co.uk Telephone 020 8906 8855

Community Corner

Swami Vivekananda Statue In Harrow (An Update).
London Kalibari in collaboration with the community at large and Harrow Council is planning to erect a statue in the grounds of Harrow Arts Centre. Harrow Council has given permission in principle and work is progressing.

The statue will be erected in front of the Dance Studio of Harrow Arts Centre. The final planning permission from Harrow Council is expected soon. Originally it was planned to use Marble dust and chemical for the statue but with the Council's suggestion it has been agreed to use Portland Stone instead. It is hoped to unveil the statue in August / September 2018. Because of the use of Portland Stone, the cost will be higher than the original estimate of between £10,000 and £15,000. Please donate to the fund by contacting Mrinal Choudhury, 020 8907 5946.

Anil Robindra Haldar
Anil is a family friend of Jayati, Ajit and Krishna. He is getting married on 22 June with Louise Kirsty Hunter. Anil met Louise 6 years ago when he was working as a junior doctor at Watford General Hospital and Louise was working as a nurse. We wish Anil and Louise a very happy future together.

Millie Basu Roy
Millie, a Kalibari associate, had her paintings displayed on 16 April In Harrow Arts Centre at the Harrow Arts Society Annual Fair.

Mrs Pratima Lahiri
Pratima died on 18 February 2018. She was born in Benares and educated in Kanpur and Bhagalpur. She qualified with a Masters Degree in Economics. She came to London in February 1967 and met Ramendra Lahiri soon afterwards. They got married in December 1967. She worked in National Westminster Bank for a few years before training as a School Teacher. For nearly 30 years she worked in Parkwood Primary School near Finsbury Park which she enjoyed very much and often talked about. She loved travelling, reading and needlework. Even during her later years when she was not well, she maintained her connections with the local Wood Green Literary Club, at which members discussed literature and books.
She leaves behind Ramendra and their daughter Devika. We send our sincere condolences to them.

Community Corner (continued)

Use of Kalibari Centre
Kalibari Centre is available for personal hire or for community activities, for example, Food Cycle in collaboration with the Edgware & Stanmore Rotary Club, Dance Classes and Bengali Language Classes.

London Kalibari Community Centre Project

London Kalibari is an organisation representing the Hindu Bengalee Community in the UK. It is an organisation with a constitution and is a charity registered in 1982 and converted into a Charitable Incorporated Organisation (CIO) in 2014. It has raised funds for the Community Centre Project through many social and cultural activities.

Our aim is to establish a permanent Community Centre in which social, cultural and spiritual activities can be held regularly. In the meantime, we have acquired a leased accommodation at **18 Byron Road, Harrow, Wealdstone, HA3 7ST**, with a main hall, two smaller rooms, kitchen and two toilets. The Centre is used for social and religious activities including a Luncheon Club on Monday at 1 pm.

A suitable larger property is estimated to cost around £1Million. A smaller property of the sort we are currently using will cost up to £500,000 with suitable alterations. We are looking to purchase the current site but no offer of sale has yet been made – we are continuing to pursue this. If we were to move to a different site, the main problem is to get permission to hold large community activities. Also, significant monies will have to be raised from the community. London Kalibari has a Building Fund and a number of members have donated £1,000 each and larger pledges have also been made. We hope you can support us in this worthy cause.

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Associated Organisations:

Sri Aurobindo Society (UK)
A Regd Charity. Address: 149 Eastcote Lane, South Harrow, HA2 8RR. On Saturdays and Sundays it is open for meditation from 6.00pm to 7.00pm. Telephone: 020 8422 9920

International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)
Hare Krishna Temple (Watford), Bhaktivedanta Manor, Dharam Marg, Hilfield Lane, Aldenham, Herts, WD25 8DT. Website: www.krishnatemple.com, Contact 01923 851000

Ramkrishna Vedenta Centra
A Regd Charity, situated in Bourn End at Blind Lane, Buckinghamshire, SL8 5LG. The centre can be accessed from M40, either Exit 3 or Exit 4. Tel: 016285 26464

Nrityakala Dance Heritage
Non profit making voluntary organisation. Address: 15 Southway, Totteridge, London N20 8EB. Phone: 797 3290373, website: www.nrityakala.org

Aid India Forum
Reg Charity No. 262210
Helping social and educational projects in India**.** Contact telephone 020 8907 5946

Gaudiya Misson (UK)
A Regd Charity Address:27 Cranhurst Road, London NW2 4LJ (near Willesden Green Tube) Contact : www.gaudiyamission.com, Tel 020 8452 2733

Hindu Pragati Sangha
Charity No 279843 (Estd 1977). Temple at 33 Rhondda Grove, London E3 5AP
Tel: 0208 8980 8752/8221/1780/8500

Vivekananda Human Centre
Vivekananda House, 2a Elmhurst Drive, South Woodford, London E18 1BT.
Tel: 020 8989 9927 and 020 7702 4100

Dr Sudin Mandal	Mrs Jayati Das	Mr Mrinal Choudhury
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